

INTRODUCTION: WHY BACKUP IS SO EASY TODAY

This chapter shows you why a Plan B is important for storing your data and an overview of the options out there

Backups – What and why

In a much-used statement, it's safe to say that we live and revel in a digital age. We're dependent on technology like never before and with increasing dependence, we've built an increased need to manage our digital lives. From blog entries and code snippets to photo albums and music libraries, our data needs have gained priority making data backup increasingly relevant. While the concept of backing up data is not new, when applied to digital content it obtains an abstract sense that varies from the usual method of backing up important documents (creating photo copies).

However, in principle it's quite the same. Digital media is important, so you create backups. Simple. The reasons to back up your data are crystal clear. Our gadgets contain important and sometimes sensitive data that's extremely vulnerable to various attacks and modes of failure. In such an event, an efficient contingency strategy can be life saving, sometimes in the literal sense!